



Social Media – Listening

Listening 1: Is Our Attention for Sale? James Williams

<https://www.thersa.org/video/shorts/2020/is-our-attention-for-sale>

1. Complete the following quote from Herbert Simon: “When information becomes ----- attention becomes a scare -----.”
2. What goals does technology have for us?
3. Which two trends have come together in the current attention economy?
4. What does this development mean according to the speaker and why it is important?
5. What was the mistake that Aldous Huxley identified?



Listening 2: The Battle for Your Time: Exposing the Costs of Social Media, Dino Ambrosi

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4TMPXK9tw5U>

1. What proportion of an average American 18-year-old's free time is taken up with screen time?
2. What does the speaker ask the audience to image?
3. What are some of the consequences of the use we make of social media sites?
Note down the examples the speaker provides? Instagram/Snapchat/Twitter
4. What does the inherent structure of a book compel us to do?
5. Which 2 things does the speaker suggest social media platforms need to do in order to monetise its users?
6. What is their profit linked to?
7. What 2 things does the speaker suggest people need to do in order to get a good deal out of social media platforms?
8. What are some of the benefits of social media that the speaker mentions?
9. What point does he make about Fear of Missing Out (FOMO)



Listening 3: Is Social Media Good for You? Cliff Lampe

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=po01VINvCcQ>

1. What is the purpose of the talk according to the speaker?
2. What is the common narrative regarding social media? Note some examples.
3. How did people perceive technology in the past in terms of its impact on human being?
4. What has the speaker been studying for the last ten years?
5. What does he say about communication?
6. How does social media play a role in developing social capital?
7. What is it about social media that allows these relationships to develop?
8. What 2 things do we need to do to increase our chances of benefiting from social media?

Follow up discussion.

In light of what you have listened to today, which speaker do you find most persuasive and does it make you consider changes to your own use of social media?